as an ascetic or a teacher. Expectations also differed for visiting scholar monks). Admission was based on an applicant's knowledge of foundational Buddhist texts and readiness for celibacy and monastic life. Its pedagogy also hewed closer to the traditional *guru-shishya parampara* or master–disciple lineage. With these caveats, however, it's reasonable to regard Nalanda as the first great university of the world.[16]



Figure 7. Rooms inside a monastery

Nalanda hosted many grand masters of Indian philosophy. Among them was Dignaga (480–540), who laid a new theoretical foundation for logic and epistemology, positing perception and inference as the only means of knowledge. His intellectual disciple at Nalanda, Dharmakirti (550–610), critiqued and advanced his ideas. Together, their work 'provoked the most sophisticated and most important philosophical debates with non-Buddhist rivals' and came to represent 'Buddhism in pan-Indian debates on problems of universals, philosophies of logic and language, and issues of justification'.[17] Indeed, many of their ideas even anticipated the work of modern European philosophers.